

LIMIT YOUR ONLINE TIME

Gah! look at the time, is it 02:00 am already? Ever had to exclaim and ask this question when you were busy with something that you're not supposed to waste time on? We know, we have. The Internet is both – man's greatest creation as well as the most disruptive. It's very easy to get lost in the countless pages online while you're working and all it takes to reach there is just a simple distraction that can be in the form of a harmless looking link which ends up being fatally harmful to your time. We're sure we all get some or the other page recommended by our peers that we should visit. This page, be it an article on a blog or a GIF of a cat playing a piano on Reddit can act as a trigger for time wasting. Although it's okay to have fun once in a while, investment of long periods of time on unrelated content can work like a dagger to stab your productivity and this is why you need something that can limit this pursuit of unwanted time wastage and we are here to help. Let's take a look at browser extensions, software or apps and how to configure them to best restrict you from wasting time online.

StayFocusd (Browser Extension)

Over time, StayFocusd has been one of the most recommended extensions for Chrome to limit time wastage and rightly so. It has a wealth of features at its disposal and is highly configurable depending on a user's usage scenario. Download and install StayFocusd from here: http://dgit.in/Stay_Focusd to get started.

Adding pages to blocked list

First you'll need to identify which websites you visit and



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waste time on the most. Social networks like Facebook and Twitter are the obvious guesses. We'll be using 9GAG and Reddit as examples here. But it all depends on which websites you know waste your time the most online. To flag an unproductive site using StayFocusd and add it to its list, navigate to the desired page and click on the blue StayFocusd button on the toolbar. A drop-down will appear with an option to block the whole website, clicking which will add it to the list. Keep clicking on the StayFocusd button to add more time wasting websites to its controlled list.

Limiting time and adding active days or hours

StayFocusd is configured to allow you 10 minutes to browse the sites in the blocked list but you can use the extension settings to increase or decrease the maximum allotted time. Click on StayFocusd button > Settings > Max Time allowed to set the maximum number of minutes per day that you'll be allowed to browse the website in your blocked list. Keep in mind that

the time limit you set will be universal for all the sites in the list and not for only a selected site. So if 10 minutes is more than enough to mindlessly pour on 9GAG in a day, then that's it and set it so. Also once you've set this number and the browsing time for that particular website has expired, you won't be able

during your happy hours, you have the option to set time periods during the day when StayFocusd should be active. So if the time from morning to the evening around 4:00 is your working time during the weekdays, you can set StayFocusd to be active only until 4:00pm on weekdays. To set active hours and days, follow this: Right-click on StayFocusd > Options > Active Days and select the days in the week that you want StayFocusd to be active say Monday to Friday. Follow the same path above and select Active Hours from the list and adjust the clock using the start and end timers given on the settings page to set active hours per day.

Make disabling StayFocusd a challenge

If you're one of those persons who isn't level headed when it comes to wasting time online, you'll definitely try to disable StayFocusd in one way or another. The developers had a well thought out idea for users like you and that is why once



Don't be surprised if it gives you some lip.

to make changes to the allotted time for that day.

To check how much time you have left to browse, click on the StayFocusd button and you'll see a timer running displaying the remaining browsing time. We don't work throughout the day and if you don't want StayFocusd playing your nanny

you've passed the allotted time frame for the day, you cannot remove a flagged site from its list or change the allocated time. To make it more difficult, you can enable challenge mode which would require you to complete a challenge before you can access any settings in StayFocusd. Enable it through